# Course Comparison: A25590BS vs. Durham Tech, Alamance CC and AB Tech AI Programs

*Central Carolina Community College – Information Technology-Business Systems & Operations Support AAS (A25590BS)*

## Programs Compared

| College | Program | Program Code | Credit Hours |
|---|---|---|---|
| Central Carolina CC (CCCC) | IT – Business Systems & Operations Support AAS | A25590BS | 67 |
| Durham Technical CC | IT – Artificial Intelligence AAS (new Fall 2026) | A25590R | 68 |
| Alamance CC | Artificial Intelligence AAS | A25710 | 64–65 |
| Asheville-Buncombe Technical CC (AB Tech) | IT: Artificial Intelligence AAS | A25590 AI pathway (code not shown on program page) | 64 |

*Updated November 7, 2026: the course lists for Durham Tech, Alamance and AB Tech were checked against each college's official program page or catalog (see Sources). Section 3 lists the corrections to the earlier "top 15 colleges" document.*

## 1. Courses Common to All Three Colleges

Each of these courses is confirmed on the official program pages of Durham Tech, Alamance and AB Tech. The last two columns show whether each one is also in the A25590BS program.

| Course | Course Name | In A25590BS? | Where in A25590BS / Note |
|---|---|---|---|
| **CSC 113** | Artificial Intelligence Fundamentals | **Yes** | 2nd semester (spring) |
| **CSC 114** | Artificial Intelligence I | **No** | Not in program |
| **CSC 121** | Python Programming | **No** | The programming elective is C++, Visual BASIC or Java |

**Summary:** The verified overlap among the three AI programs is smaller than the "top 15" document suggested. Only three courses are confirmed at all three colleges, and they are the AI/Python core: CSC 113, CSC 114 and CSC 121. That matches the required core of the state A25710 Artificial Intelligence standard (CSC 113, 114, 115, 121). A25590BS has CSC 113 but not CSC 114 or CSC 121.

### Courses confirmed at two of the three colleges

*Several of these may also be in Alamance's program. Its first three semesters couldn't be retrieved from its online catalog (see Section 3).*

| Course | Course Name | Offered By | In A25590BS? |
|---|---|---|---|
| **CTI 110** | IT Foundations | Durham, AB Tech | Yes – 1st semester |
| **CTI 120** | Network & Security Foundations | Durham, AB Tech | Yes – 1st semester |
| **CTS 115** | Info Sys Business Concepts | Durham, AB Tech | Yes – 1st semester |
| **DBA 120** | Database Programming I | Durham, AB Tech | Yes – 5th semester |
| **ENG 111** | Writing & Inquiry | Durham, AB Tech | Yes – 3rd semester |
| **CSC 115** | Machine Learning I | Durham, Alamance | No |

| Course | Course Name | Offered By | In A25590BS? |
|---|---|---|---|
| **MAT 171** | Precalculus Algebra | Durham, Alamance | Yes – math option |
| **CTS 130** | Spreadsheet | Alamance, AB Tech | No |

## 2. Combined Course List by Subject Area

This table lists every course in the four programs, grouped by subject area. ✓ = required course; "Option", "Elective" or "Recommended" = one choice in a select-one list or elective category.

| Course | Course Name | CCCC A25590BS | Durham Tech | Alamance† | AB Tech |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning** | | | | | |
| **CSC 113** | Artificial Intelligence Fundamentals | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
| **CSC 114** | Artificial Intelligence I | | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
| **CSC 115** | Machine Learning I | | ✓ | ✓ | |
| **CSC 117** | Artificial Intelligence Tools I | | | | ✓ |
| **CSC 128** | Chatbot Programming I | | ✓ | | |
| **CSC 161** | Deep Learning | | ✓ | | |
| **Programming & Software Development** | | | | | |
| **CSC 121** | Python Programming | | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
| **CSC 122** | Python Application Development | | | | ✓ |
| **CSC 221** | Advanced Python Programming | | ✓ | | |
| **CIS 115** | Intro to Prog & Logic | ✓ | | | |
| **CSC 134** | C++ Programming | Elective | | | |
| **CSC 139** | Visual BASIC Programming | Elective | | | |
| **CSC 151** | JAVA Programming | Elective | | | |
| **Database & Data Analytics** | | | | | |
| **DBA 110** | Database Concepts | ✓ | ✓ | | |
| **DBA 120** | Database Programming I | ✓ | ✓ | | ✓ |
| **DBA 210** | Database Administration | | | | ✓ |
| **BAS 120** | Intro to Analytics | | ✓ | | |
| **CTS 130** | Spreadsheet | | | ✓ | ✓ |
| **IT Foundations, Business Systems & Support** | | | | | |
| **CTI 110** | IT Foundations (Web, Pgm & Db Foundation) | ✓ | ✓ | | ✓ |
| **CTI 120** | Network & Security Foundations | ✓ | ✓ | | ✓ |
| **CTS 115** | Info Sys Business Concepts | ✓ | ✓ | | ✓ |
| **CTS 120** | Hardware/Software Support | ✓ | Option | | |
| **CIS 110** | Intro to Computers | Elective | Option | | |
| **CET 111** | Computer Upgrade/Repair I | | | | ✓ |
| **CTS 217** | Computer Training/Support | | | | ✓ |
| **Operating Systems, Virtualization & Infrastructure** | | | | | |
| **NOS 110** | Operating Systems Concepts | | | | ✓ |

| Course | Course Name | CCCC A25590BS | Durham Tech | Alamance† | AB Tech |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **NOS 120** | Linux/UNIX Single User | ✓ | | ✓ | |
| **NOS 130** | Windows Single User | ✓ | | | |
| **NOS 230** | Windows Administration I | ✓ | | | |
| **CTI 140** | Virtualization Concepts | Elective | | | |
| **Security & Ethics** | | | | | |
| **SEC 110** | Security Concepts | ✓ | | | |
| **CTS 210** | Computer Ethics | | | | ✓ |
| **Web & Mobile Development** | | | | | |
| **WEB 115** | Web Markup & Scripting | ✓ | | | |
| **WEB 151** | Mobile Applications Dev I | ✓ | | | |
| **Capstone & Work-Based Learning** | | | | | |
| **CTI 289** | CTI Capstone Project | ✓ | | | |
| **CSC 289** | Programming Capstone Project | | ✓ | | |
| **CTS 289** | System Support Project | | | | ✓ |
| **WBL 110 / 111** | World of Work / Work-Based Learning I | | ✓ | | |
| **General Education & College Success** | | | | | |
| **ACA 122** | Transfer & Career Success | ✓ | ✓ | | |
| **ACA 115** | Success & Study Skills | | | | ✓ |
| **ENG 111** | Writing & Inquiry | ✓ | ✓ | | ✓ |
| **ENG 112** | Writing/Research in the Disciplines | | ✓ | | |
| **COM 231** | Public Speaking | | | | ✓ |
| **MAT 110** | Math Measurement & Literacy | | | | ✓ |
| **MAT 143** | Quantitative Literacy | Option | | | |
| **MAT 152** | Statistical Methods I | | ✓ | | |
| **MAT 171** | Precalculus Algebra | Option | ✓ | ✓ | |
| **ART 111** | Art Appreciation (Hum/Fine Arts) | | | | ✓ |
| **PSY 150** | General Psychology (Soc/Behavioral) | | Recommended | | ✓ |

*Green in the CCCC column = the course is in A25590BS. Gray = confirmed at all three other colleges.*

*† Alamance column: only the courses that could be confirmed in Alamance's online catalog (2024-2025 Catalog, semesters 4-5) are marked. Its first three semesters (13, about 15 and 6 credit hours) couldn't be retrieved, so other courses there may also be in its program.*

## 3. Corrections to the "Top 15 Colleges" Document

Comparing the earlier source document with the colleges' official pages turned up these differences:

| What the "top 15" document said | What the official sources show |
|---|---|
| CSC 213 listed as a core AI course at all three colleges | None of the three official program pages lists CSC 213. The Durham Tech and Alamance AI courses after CSC 114 are CSC 115 Machine Learning I (both), plus CSC 128 Chatbot Programming I and CSC 161 Deep Learning at Durham Tech. |
| CSC 114 called "Artificial Intelligence Tools" | CSC 114 is "Artificial Intelligence I" at all three colleges. AB Tech also has a separate course, CSC 117 Artificial Intelligence Tools I. |
| Durham Tech program code A25590R | Confirmed: Information Technology – Artificial Intelligence, Associate Degree (A25590R), new for Fall 2026, 68 credit hours. |
| Durham Tech: CCT 231 and CTS 289 | Not in Durham Tech's plan of study. Its capstone is CSC 289 Programming Capstone Project, and it adds WBL 110/111 work-based learning. |
| AB Tech: CTS 120, CTS 240, CTS 285, DBA 220, ACA 122, CSC 213 | Not in AB Tech's 2026-2027 program. AB Tech requires CTS 210 Computer Ethics, DBA 210 Database Administration, NOS 110, CET 111, CTS 130, CTS 217, CSC 117, CSC 122 and ACA 115. |
| AB Tech total 64-65 hours | AB Tech lists 64 credit hours. Its program page doesn't show a program code. |
| Alamance: CTI 110, CTI 120, NOS 110, CSC 151, CCT 231, CTS 289, DBA 120 | These couldn't be confirmed. The parts of Alamance's catalog that could be retrieved list CSC 113, CSC 114, CSC 115, CSC 121, CTS 130, NOS 120 (not NOS 110), MAT 171 and a major elective. The total is 64-65 credit hours. |

## 4. Key Observations

- **Shared IT foundation.** A25590BS shares the IT foundation block with Durham Tech and AB Tech: CTI 110, CTI 120, CTS 115, DBA 120 and ENG 111, plus CSC 113.
- **AI core gap.** All three AI programs require CSC 114 and CSC 121 (Python), and Durham Tech and Alamance also require CSC 115 (Machine Learning I). A25590BS has none of these. Adding CSC 114 and CSC 121 would cover the confirmed overlap.
- **Python vs. other languages.** All three colleges teach Python, and Durham Tech and AB Tech add a second Python course (CSC 221 or CSC 122). A25590BS offers C++, Visual BASIC or Java, and none of the three AI programs requires those.
- **Infrastructure emphasis.** A25590BS has more Windows administration, security and web/mobile coursework (NOS 130, NOS 230, SEC 110, WEB 115, WEB 151, CTI 140), which fits its business systems and operations support focus. NOS 120 Linux is the only one of these that also appears in an AI program (Alamance).
- **Ethics.** AB Tech requires CTS 210 Computer Ethics. Durham Tech covers ethical and responsible AI use within its coursework rather than in a separate required course.
- **Capstone.** Each college uses a different capstone: CTI 289 at CCCC, CSC 289 at Durham Tech and CTS 289 at AB Tech.

## Sources


- CCCC A25590BS Program Planning Guide (Effective 2026 Fall)
- Durham Tech – IT Artificial Intelligence AAS (A25590R) Plan of Study 2026-2027 – https://www.durhamtech.edu/sites/default/files/printable/2026/2026-2027-IT-Artificial-Intelligence-AAS.pdf
- Durham Tech – Artificial Intelligence AAS program page – https://www.durhamtech.edu/programs-pathways/artificial-intelligence-aas

- AB Tech – Information Technology: Artificial Intelligence A.A.S. (2026-2027 catalog) – https://abtech.edu/program/information-technology-artificial-intelligence-aas
- Alamance CC – Artificial Intelligence A.A.S. (A25710), 2024-2025 Catalog – https://catalog.alamancecc.edu/preview_program.php?catoid=7&poid=1192&returnto=839
- Alamance CC – Artificial Intelligence program page – https://alamancecc.edu/curriculum_programs/business-arts-and-science/ai.php
- NCCCS Curriculum Standard – Artificial Intelligence A25710 (Fall 2022)

*Course information was checked on November 7, 2026. Confirm with each college before publishing, especially for Alamance.*